

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



PRIME MINISTERS IN SUCCESSION

MODULE - 10

FOREIGN POLICY UNDER PM DEVEGOWDA

Though the tenure as the Prime Minister of India was limited, some of the important foreign policy initiatives taken by HD Deve Gowda are as follows:

RELATIONS WITH PAKISTAN

- 1 Relations with Pakistan improved and formal talks began.
- 2 The initiative was taken by Pakistani PM Bhutto as she wanted to find solutions for lasting peace.
- 3 But India was cautious and wanted a 'step-by-step' resumption of talks.
- 4 Pakistan ratified SAPTA and gave India the status of Most favoured Nation to promote trade.



FOREIGN POLICY UNDER PM DEVEGOWDA

IK GUJRAL

- 1 Appointment of IK Gujral as the Foreign minister, the longest-serving ambassador to Soviet Union.
- 2 His initiatives especially towards the neighbours were noteworthy.
- 3 He felt that India should focus on its neighbours than receive given the threat perception against India in South Asia.



FOREIGN POLICY UNDER PM DEVEGOWDA

STRENGTHENING SAARC

- SAARC was seen with the hope of attracting foreign investment in the region.
- This made it imperative for neighbours to have friendly relations with India.



VISIT TO DAVOS

- PM Deve Gowda visit Davos in 1997 and continued to woo investors by trying to showcase a business-friendly and investor-friendly India, free from corruption.
- He said he had impressed foreign investors and instilled confidence to visit India.



FOREIGN POLICY OF PM DEVEGOWDA

CTBT AND NUCLEAR DISARMAMENT

- 1 India's relations with USA became challenging because US was insisting India to sign the CTBT without linking it to conditions like time-bound program for nuclear disarmament.
- 2 PM stated India's stand and said that India stood for a complete ban on nuclear weapons, complete disarmament.
- 3 It did not approve of the discriminatory treatment and a difference between haves and have nots in the nuclear domain.
- 4 The nuclear weapon states cannot insist India and others to sign CTBT. India has to focus on its own national interest and security considerations.



FOREIGN POLICY OF PM DEVEGOWDA

RELATIONS WITH SRI LANKA

- PM said India did not want to interfere in the internal matters and sovereign affairs of Sri Lanka.
- He wanted to maintain friendly and cordial relations with the neighbour.

VISIT TO MAURITIUS

- Mauritius was growing as a geopolitical and economic ally in the Indian Ocean region. It supported India on the issue of CTBT and did not sign the treaty.
- During the visit of PM to Mauritius, it assured a continuation of the Double Tax Avoidance Treaty.



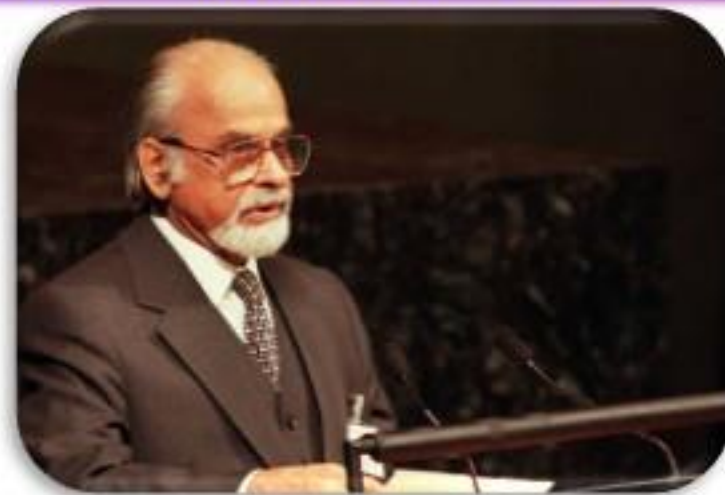
FOREIGN POLICY UNDER IK GUJRAL

GUJRAL DOCTRINE

- IK Gujral, is remembered for his foreign policy Doctrine 'Gujral Doctrine' which have been acclaimed both in India and abroad.
- It is a set of principles to guide foreign relations with India's immediate neighbours.

FEATURES OF GUJRAL DOCTRINE

- 1 India does not seek reciprocity with Bhutan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Maldives and Sri Lanka.
- 2 No South Asian country should permit its territory to be used against the interest of another south Asian nation.
- 3 All South Asian countries should respect each other's territorial integrity and sovereignty.
- 4 They should settle all their disputes via peaceful bilateral negotiations



FOREIGN POLICY UNDER IK GUJRAL

ACHIEVEMENTS OF DOCTRINE

- 1 It helped building trust between India and its neighbours.
- 2 It emphasized the importance of unilateral accommodation for friendly and warm relations with India's neighbours.
- 3 Some of the successes of the Gujral Doctrine include the enactment of the Farakka Agreement in December 1960 with Bangladesh.



FOREIGN POLICY UNDER IK GUJRAL

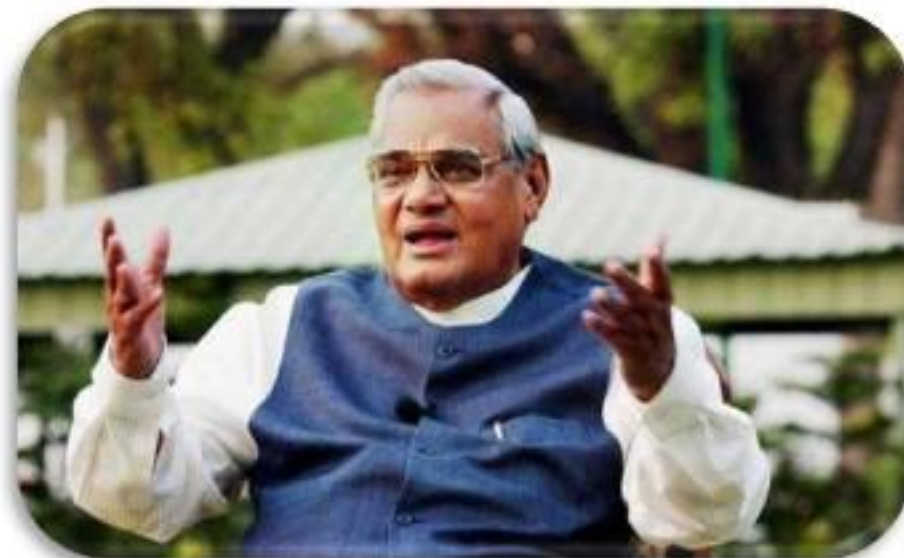
SHORTCOMINGS OF DOCTRINE

- 1 These principles are not altogether new as their have been previous instances of the principle of non-reciprocity.
- 2 However, its viability is questioned because of political instability in South Asia and strong anti-India sentiment. The principles of the can be successful only in a specific environment.
- 3 Non- reciprocity also meant that the solution to one bilateral problem would not be linked to concessions by the other country for India on an issue that the latter considers beneficial.
- 4 Non-interfere in the internal affairs of the others becomes difficult to define because the South Asian region has many similarities in terms of culture, language and other factors. Events and activities in one country influence happenings in another.



FOREIGN POLICY OF AB VAJPAYEE

- 1 PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee was known for his realism and pragmatic policy.
- 2 He was a stalwart and the first person to deliver a speech to the United Nations General Assembly in Hindi.
- 3 He was known for having taken decisions balancing geopolitical, strategic and economic interests of the country.
- 4 Some of his initiatives like the Nuclear test and relations with US were the foundations of a stronger India and paved the way for monumental agreements like Indo-US Nuclear Agreement



INDIA'S NUCLEAR PROGRAM

NUCLEAR TESTS IN POKHRAN

1 India conducted its second series of nuclear tests at Pokhran in May 1998. It conducted three underground nuclear tests in Pokhran.

2 PM Vajpayee declared to the world, "India is now a nuclear weapon state".

3 After the 1974 test, India did not declare itself a nuclear weapon state because the then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi had described the test as a peaceful nuclear explosion (PNE).

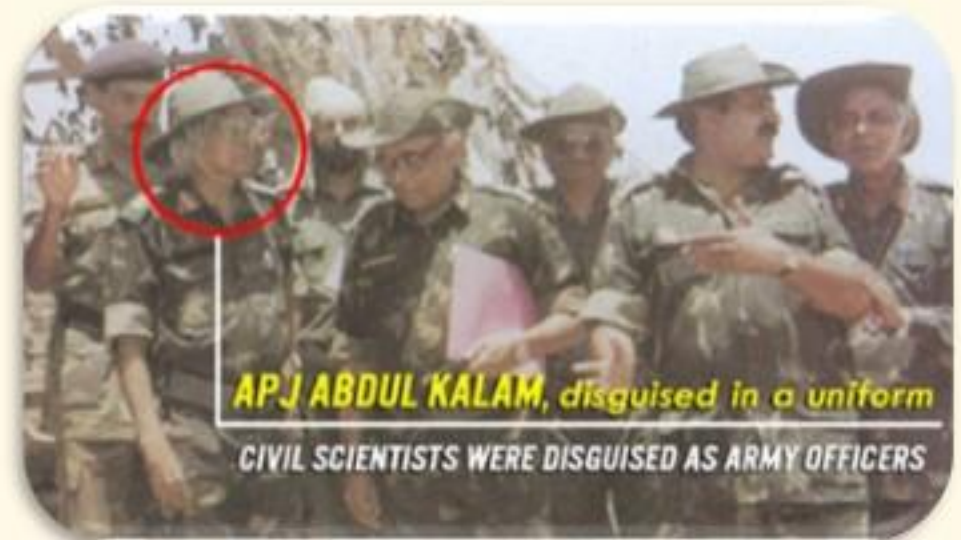
4 The declaration after 1998 tests reflected a political decision and a technical necessity in the changing geopolitical situation.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR PROGRAM

REACTIONS TO THE TEST

- 1 The test led to a global isolation and economic and military sanctions against the country.
- 2 PM Vajpayee balanced the geopolitical necessity of conducting the nuclear test with the strategic necessity of developing relations with China.
- 3 The tests were well received in India.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR PROGRAM

OUTCOME OF THE TEST

- 1** After the tests, India committed to two important stabilizing measures:
 1. An informal moratorium on further nuclear tests
 2. A commitment to "No First Use" (NFU) of nuclear weapons.
- 2** Both have become sacrosanct in India's and paved the way for the creation of the Nuclear Command Authority headed by the prime minister

- 3** It was also decided that the nuclear weapons would never be used against a non-nuclear state and remain under civilian control.



INDIA-PAKISTAN

LAHORE DECLARATION

- 1** PM Vajpayee opened the borders between India and Pakistan when he inaugurated the Delhi-Lahore Bus Yatra in 1999.
- 2** PM himself undertook a historic bus journey to Lahore in 1999 in search of peace and to sign the Lahore Declaration to strengthen India-Pakistan relations.
- 3** The Lahore Declaration proposed measures to restore confidence and normalise relations.
- 4** It was the second agreement after the Non-Nuclear Aggression Agreement, between the two countries to avoid a nuclear conflict
- 5** Unfortunately, the Lahore Declaration was soon followed by the Kargil War



KARGIL WAR

INDIA-PAKISTAN

- 1 In 1999, Pakistan Army took advantage intruded into Mushkoh, Dras, Kargil, Batalik and Turtuk sub-sectors, between Zojila and Leh.
- 2 Pakistan wanted to cut off the highway connecting Srinagar with Leh, thereby cutting off Ladakh and Siachen
- 3 India undertook Operation Vijay in May 1999 and moved to Dras to evict the intruders on May 17.
- 4 On May 20, 1999, India recaptured Tololing, since it was close to the national highway.

- 5 On May 26, the Indian Air Force (IAF) helicopter gunships fired the Pakistani bunkers. Tiger Hill was captured on July 3, 1999
- 6 Finally on July 26, the Indian Army recaptured all the Indian posts in Kargil that had been occupied by Pakistan's army.



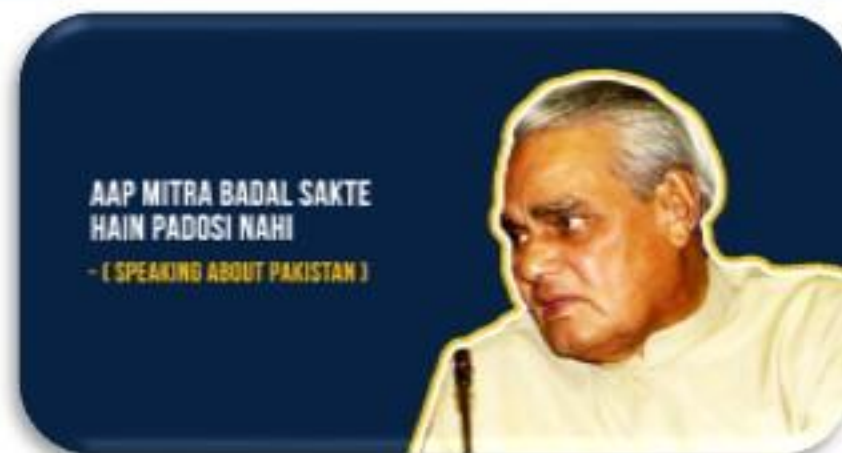
INDIA-PAKISTAN

JAMMU & KASHMIR

- 1 PM Vajpayee believed that the way to restore peace between India and Pakistan had to include the discussion of Jammu & Kashmir.
- 2 His approach towards the state was mentioned in the “Vajpayee Doctrine” on 21 April 2003 with the slogan Insaaniyat (humanity), Jamhooriyat (democracy) Kashmiriyat (culture of Kashmir)” which meant humanity, peace, and keeping the sanctity of the people of Kashmir.
- 3 He aimed to keep third-party interventions out of the India-Pakistan equation.

- 4 PM Vajpayee believed in India-Pakistan friendship be based on reciprocity and mutual trust.

- 5 He believed a collective fight against poverty and terrorism in the subcontinent would help to strengthen bonds between the two neighbours.



INDIA-PAKISTAN

TERRORIST ACTIVITIES

- 1 In December 1999 the Indian Airlines flight IC814 travelling from Kathmandu to New Delhi was hijacked and flown to Kandahar.
- 2 In response, PM Vajpayee had to release three terrorists including Masood Azhar in exchange for the hostages.
- 3 The Indian Parliament was attacked in December 2001. It led to a war like situation with Pakistan.
- 4 Violence in the border areas intensified despite commitments not to support terrorism.



In January 2004, India agreed to resume dialogue with Pakistan, following an assurance from President Pervez Musharraf that 'territory under Pakistan's control' would not be used for terrorism against India.

SAARC SUMMIT

INDO-PAK COOPERATION

An important achievement in Indo-Pak relations took place on January 6, 2004.

- 1 During a meeting with President Musharraf on the side-lines of the SAARC summit, Pakistan agreed not to support terrorism while India agreed that the two sides would begin a composite dialogue on a range of issues affecting them.
- 2 This meeting also committed SAARC to create the South Asian Free Trade Area, a common market that could, over time, become something more than that.



INDIA - CHINA

VISIT TO CHINA

PM Vajpayee visited China in spite of Jan Sangh's suspicions of China. It led to Confidence building measures between the neighbours.

With the 1998 nuclear test, India became equal to China in nuclear capability. PM Vajpayee visited China in 2003. During the visit-

- 1 India officially recognized Tibetan Autonomous Region(TAR) as a part of mainland China
- 2 India instituted a Special Representatives(SR) mechanism to resolve border dispute between India and China

- 3 High-level mechanisms for dispute resolution were instituted

- The Chinese counterpart Huang Hua was assured that the boundary issue should not act as a hindrance in the improvement of bilateral relations.
- India de-emphasized the border issue in the overall context of bilateral relations.



INDIA- UNITED STATES

INDIA'S "NATURAL ALLY"

One of PM Vajpayee's remarkable achievements include strengthening relations with USA.

- 1 In spite of the sanctions imposed after the nuclear test, PM Vajpayee characterized USA as a "natural ally" and launched the Next Steps in Strategic Partnership in 2004.
- 2 The foundations of bilateral cooperation between India and the United States were laid by increased cooperation in the commerce, defence, and technology spheres during Vajpayee's tenure laid.



INDIA- UNITED STATES

STATE VISITS BETWEEN INDIA AND USA

- 1 In January 2000, US President Bill Clinton came on a state visit to India.
- 2 During this visit the two sides signed a comprehensive document – 'India Relations: A Vision for the 21st Century' – which laid the foundation that transformed Indo-US ties.
- 3 It was important because after a gap of 22 years that an American President was visiting India.
- 4 PM Vajpayee reciprocated with a visit to US the same year in September.



INDIA AND THE WORLD

- 1 India also developed strong ties with other countries like Russia, France, Israel, Iran and multilateral groupings such as ASEAN and EU.
- 2 PM Vajpayee also visited Vietnam and Indonesia and signed trade and commercial agreements.
- 3 In June 2000, the first India-EU summit took place in Lisbon.
- 4 In 2001, the 'Moscow Declaration' signed in 2001 between PM Vajpayee and President Putin. It marked the beginning of a close security and trade relationship with Russia.
- 5 It was also agreed that the Indo-Russian annual summit would be held alternatively in the two countries



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